



Google Search Console Checklist

The free tool most small business owners never open — and what to check when they finally do.

SETUP

- ☐ Property is verified — a domain property is preferred over a URL-prefix property when possible
- ☐ An XML sitemap has been submitted
- ☐ A preferred domain (www vs. non-www) is set consistently via redirects

ONGOING WATCH

- ☐ Check new top queries — are you ranking for terms you did not expect, for better or worse?
- ☐ Confirm the Mobile Usability report shows no new errors
- ☐ Any sudden spike or drop in impressions gets investigated, not ignored

MONTHLY CHECK

- ☐ Review the Coverage/Indexing report for errors — 404s, redirect issues, accidental noindex tags
- ☐ Review the Core Web Vitals report for any "Poor" URLs
- ☐ Check Search Analytics — has clicks or impressions dropped meaningfully?
- ☐ Review the Manual Actions report — it should stay empty
- ☐ Check the Security Issues report